

► PIGEON MESSAGE CAPSULE

Date 1914–1918

Origin UK

Type Message dispatch

During the war, thousands of messenger pigeons were used by the British and German armies. Messages written on rice paper and folded to fit into containers such as this were attached to the birds' legs.



Leg clip

Message capsule



Plaited cord lanyard

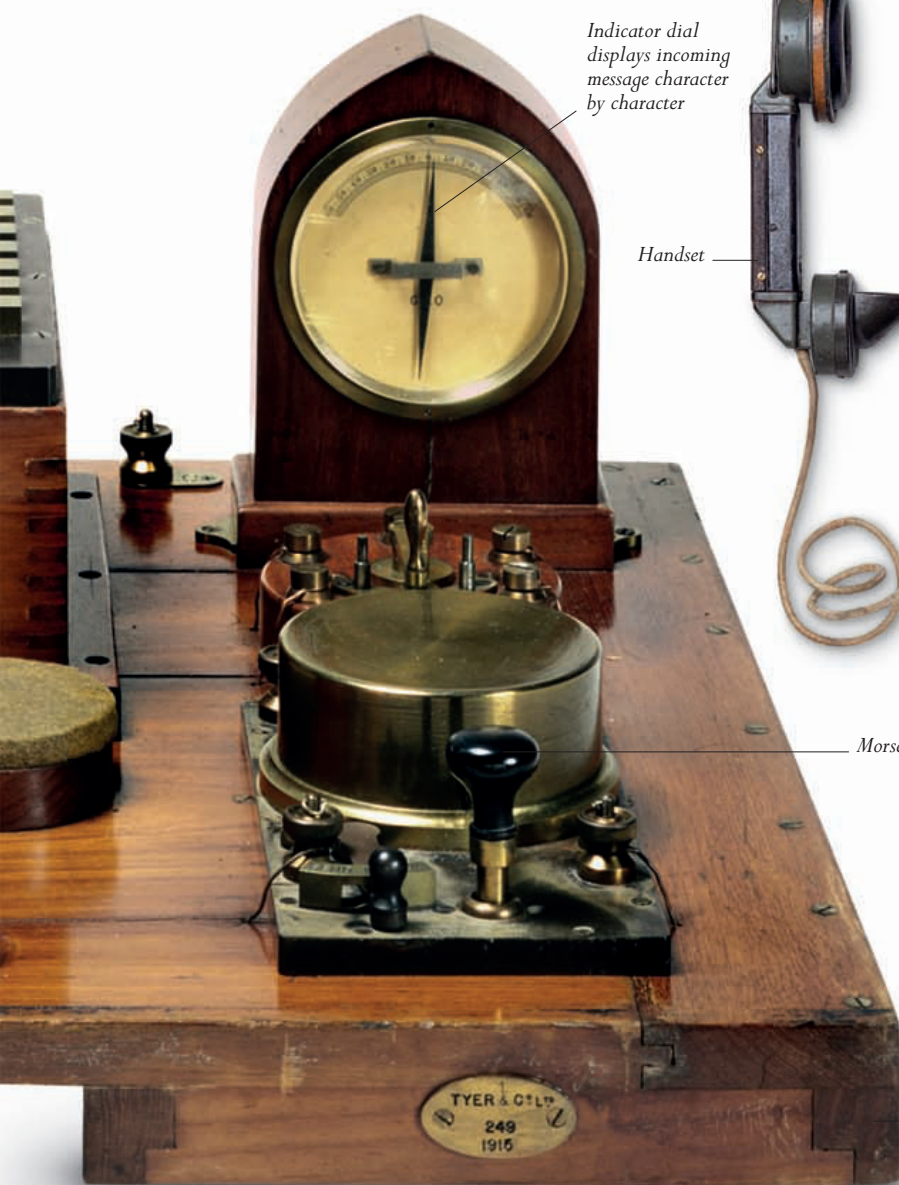
▲ SIGNALLING WHISTLE

Date 1914

Origin UK

Type Signalling

A whistle-blast was the usual signal for pre-planned actions, such as an assault or a machine-gun barrage. This example was used by an Australian officer in the Egyptian Expeditionary Force.



Indicator dial displays incoming message character by character

Handset

Morse key

TYER & CO LTD
249
1915



Cocking handle

27mm flare

▲ FLARE PISTOL

Date 1907

Origin Germany

Type Signalling

This 27mm calibre flare pistol is of simple steel and wood construction. The firing mechanism consists of a sprung cocking handle, which acts as a firing pin when released by the trigger.



Flare cartridges

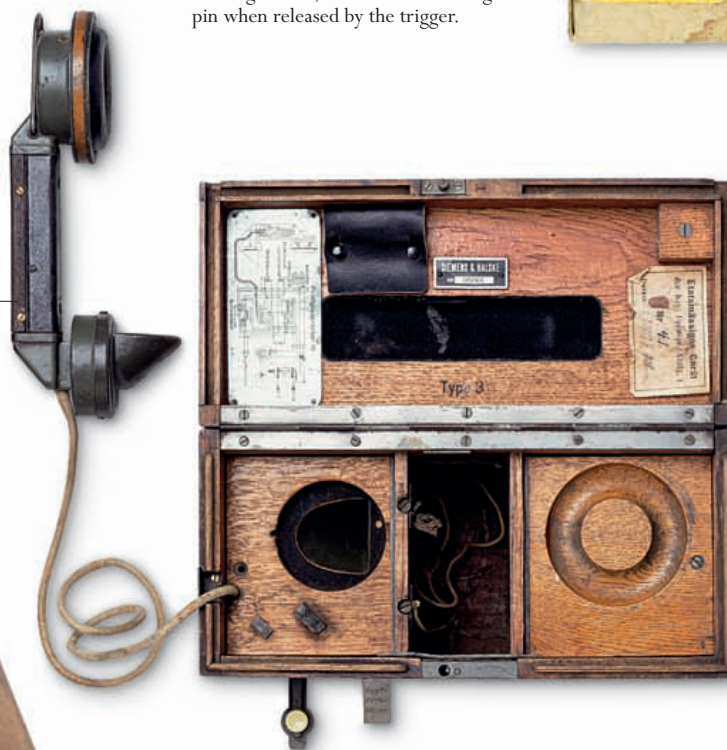
◀ FIELD TELEPHONE

Date 1914–1918

Origin Germany

Type Telephony

Field telephones were used extensively throughout World War I, mostly to allow front-line units to communicate with headquarters to the rear. However, they relied on cables that were extremely fragile and had to be repaired frequently.



Cutaway for the nose

Handle

Wooden baseboard

◀ MEGAPHONE

Date 1915

Origin UK

Type Signalling

This loudhailer megaphone was recovered from the area known as Shrapnel Gully at Anzac Cove on the Gallipoli Peninsula, together with other artefacts used by 2nd Field Company, Royal Australian Engineers, between 25 April and 20 December, 1915.

